The Guardian

one stop english

How to quit fast fashion: 'Sometimes we don't need retail therapy, we need actual therapy'

Level 3: Intermediate – Teacher's notes

Article summary: The article describes how four different people have quit fast fashion and encourages the reader to follow in their footsteps.

Time: 60 minutes

Skills: Reading, Speaking, Writing

Language focus: Vocabulary (collocations)

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. You can first elicit the meaning of the three terms and then get students to check the definitions. The purpose of this activity is to introduce the topic of fast fashion and to get students thinking about their relationship to it as well as its impact on the environment.

2. Key words

a. Ask students to do the exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs or small groups. Note that *vibe* is an informal word. You can also ask students to scan the article for these words and to look at how they are used in context. If you want to extend this activity, you can get students to explore the different parts of speech e.g., *consciousness*, *browse*, *desire*, *ethical*, *engaging*.

Key:

1. *b (conscious)*
2. *c (impact)*
3. *a (vibe)*
4. *a (turning point)*
5. *c (browser)*
6. *b (desirable)*
7. *a (ethics)*
8. *c (panic)*
9. *c (engage)*
10. *a (shift)*

3. Comprehension check

a. Students find the statements in the text and identify the speaker in each case. Encourage students to underline the part of the text where they find the answer.

Key:

1. *Maggie Zhou*
2. *Chris Cheers*
3. *Nico Idour*
4. *Wendy Syfret*
5. *Chris Cheers*
6. *Nico Idour*
7. *Maggie Zhou*
8. *Lauren Bravo*
9. *Wendy Syfret*
10. *Lauren Bravo*

4. Key language

a. Students could be asked to do this exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs. Encourage them to check their answers by looking for the answers in the text.

Key:

1. *up*
2. *in*
3. *over / about*
4. *up (for)*
5. *in*
6. *on*

b. Ask students to work individually or in pairs and choose three phrases they want to learn and remember. Have them write a question with each of their chosen phrases. Then regroup students so they work in new pairs or groups and take turns to ask and answer their questions. Encourage them to pay attention to the other students' answers and check that they are using the phrases correctly.

5. Discussion

a. Allow students time to note down their ideas about each statement and encourage them to say why they agree or disagree with each one.

6. In your own words

a. The task could also be done as a homework task and students could then email each other (and you).

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